SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #95 · CHURCH & AUTHORITY

“Being busy at church means being spiritual.”

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Where it often comes from

A church culture that praises the people who do the most. Feeling guilty when you say no to a ministry. Finding your identity in your church roles. Exhaustion or burnout from serving. Confusing activity with intimacy with God.

What Scripture teaches

Serving the church is good, but busyness is not the same as spirituality. God looks at the heart, not outward appearance. What He requires is to act justly, love mercy, and walk humbly with Him. Jesus taught that fruit comes from remaining in Him, not from frantic activity. Moses’ father-in-law warned him that he would wear himself out doing too much alone. True spirituality grows from closeness to God, not a full calendar.

> *“He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?”* **(Micah 6:8)**.

Also see

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” **(1 Samuel 16:7)**.

> “I am the vine and you are the branches. The one who remains in Me, and I in him, will bear much fruit. For apart from Me you can do nothing” **(John 15:5)**.

> “‘Martha, Martha,’ the Lord replied, ‘you are worried and upset about many things. But only one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, and it will not be taken away from her.’” **(Luke 10:41–42)**.

> “But Moses’ father-in-law said to him, ‘What you are doing is not good. Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone.’” **(Exodus 18:17–18)**.

Common self-statements

- The more I do at church, the more spiritual I am.
- If I step back, I’m letting God down.
- Busy Christians are the best Christians.
- I don’t have time to rest; there’s too much ministry.
- My worth comes from my church roles.
- Saying no is unspiritual.

Common logical errors

- **Equating activity with intimacy:** Believing doing more for God means being closer to Him.
- **Should statements:** “I should say yes to every ministry need.”
- **Comparison:** Measuring spirituality by visible service.
- **Neglect:** Ignoring rest, family, and your own soul for church activity.

Challenging questions

- What does God require, according to Micah 6:8?
- Does God look at my calendar or my heart?
- Where does lasting fruit come from, according to John 15:5?
- What did Jesus say to busy Martha?
- Am I serving from love or from pressure?
- What might I need to step back from?
- What does walking humbly with God look like for me?

Truth summary

> Being busy at church does not mean being spiritual. God looks at my heart. He asks me to act justly, love mercy, and walk humbly with Him. Lasting fruit comes from remaining in Jesus. I can serve with joy, and I can also rest, say no, and spend time with Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Servant
- Church
- Tired
- Humility
- Worship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Being busy at church means being spiritual"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Being busy at church means being spiritual." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does God require of me?
- ☐ Does God look at my calendar or heart?
- ☐ Where does lasting fruit come from?
- ☐ What did Jesus say to Martha?
- ☐ Am I serving from love or pressure?
- ☐ What might I need to step back from?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Busyness is not the same as spirituality.
- ☐ God looks at my heart.
- ☐ Fruit comes from remaining in Jesus.
- ☐ I can serve with joy and also rest.
- ☐ Saying no can be wise and faithful.
- ☐ I can walk humbly with God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Micah 6:8**
  "He has shown you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your God?"
- [ ] **1 Samuel 16:7**
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- [ ] **John 15:5**
  "I am the vine and you are the branches. The one who remains in Me, and I in him, will bear much fruit. For apart from Me you can do nothing."
- [ ] **Luke 10:41–42**
  "'Martha, Martha,' the Lord replied, 'you are worried and upset about many things. But only one thing is necessary. Mary has chosen the good portion, and it will not be taken away from her.'"
- [ ] **Exodus 18:17–18**
  "But Moses' father-in-law said to him, 'What you are doing is not good. Surely you and these people with you will wear yourselves out, because the task is too heavy for you. You cannot handle it alone.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Abiding log:** Each day, write one way I spent time with God, not just doing things for Him.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Micah 6:8 becomes: "He has shown **Sarah** what is good. And what does the LORD require of **her** but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with **her** God?"*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Servant" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **List all your church commitments,** and pray about one you may need to step back from.
- ☐ **Take one evening off from church activities this week** and spend part of it alone with God.
- ☐ **Read Exodus 18:13–27,** and write what Moses learned about sharing the load.
- ☐ **Talk with a church leader** about a healthy level of service for this season.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Being busy at church means being spiritual": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Time spent with God, not just for Him
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Being busy at church means being spiritual.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You look at my heart. Help me reject the lie that being busy at church means being spiritual. Teach me to remain in Jesus, to serve out of love, and to rest without guilt. Show me what to keep and what to let go. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.